

2009: The Year of Revival

JANUARY 11, 2010

Political stability, the economy weathering a global crisis, corporate performance, Test cricket triumphs, slumdog millionaires; 2009 didn't turn out to be so bad after all.



“With political stability at the Centre, we have weathered the economic storm better than even developed countries. However, the rising prices of essential goods remain a matter of concern.”

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

The Year That Was

Your special issue has factually narrated the revival of several aspects—from the economy to sports—but failed short of describing the fortunes of the so-called *aam aadmi* (“2009: The Year of Revival”, January 11). The common man’s fortune failed to revive in 2009. He emerged severely battered confronting fear of terrorism, caste and religious turbulence, ever increasing prices, unabated corruption, deaths from diseases and poverty and became a victim of miserable governance. In my view, revival of all the aspects is useless if they fail to revive the fortunes of the common man.

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

An important aspect of 2009, seemingly the year



The New Mr Clean

There is no doubt that Rahul Gandhi has emerged from his mother’s shadow and proven his credentials, despite having the heavy burden of the surname on his shoulders (“Rahul Gandhi: The Catalyst”, January 4). However, he must not lose perspective amidst the dirty world of Indian politics. If he can combine the qualities of both his father and grandmother, he would certainly be a strong political force to look up to in the future.

V.K. TANGRI, *Varanasi*

Rahul Gandhi is an antithesis of a typical power-hungry Indian politician. He’s like a whiff of fresh air in our political firmament, has a pleasing and affable nature, abhors extravagance and is keen on cleaning the Congress’s Aegian stables.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

of revival, was that it was women who assumed a more important role than ever in Indian politics. Sonia Gandhi, Sushma Swaraj, Mamata Banerjee and Meira Kumar were some of the success stories of 2009.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Inevitable India

Be it the climate summit at Copenhagen or the G8+5 Summit, India has proved that it has come into its own, and its role in global matters cannot be wished away (“In the Big League Now”, January 11). Unfortunately, even if it has no history of being expansionist, the fact that it has become a force to reckon with in the global polity today is precisely why its neighbours like China, Pakistan and Nepal

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